

William Preston Leslie II (Preferred: Preston Carey Leslie)

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Jul 9, 2026

Erika Monroe

Executive Recruitment and Selection Panel

Seattle Public Utilities

700 5th Ave, Seattle, WA 98104

RE: Application for Senior Executive Assistant (Project Delivery & Engineering Branch)

Dear Erika Monroe and Members of the Selection Panel:

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Senior Executive Assistant position supporting the leadership team within the Project Delivery & Engineering Branch (PDEB) at Seattle Public Utilities. As an operations specialist and systems translator with 14 years of experience navigating high-stress, high-concurrency organizational workflows, I excel at serving as the connective tissue between executive strategy and front-line execution. Having finalized my relocation logistics, I am currently in a position to deploy to the Pacific Northwest and onboard immediately without relocation-related delays.

My professional blueprint is built on taking an analytical scalpel to operational workflows, rather than a cleaver. When massive municipal structures face shifting constraints, it is easy for leadership to inadvertently disrupt the human infrastructure that keeps projects moving. Throughout my career, whether managing decentralized field assets or auditing data mapping for an 18,000-user enterprise software transition, I have specialized in protecting database integrity and identifying organizational static before it causes systemic paralysis. I bring a rigorous Master of Science in Quantitative Methods from Baruch College, which allows me to anchor administrative problem-solving in structured data, ensuring the branch's upcoming 2025–2030 strategic technology and capital milestones are executed transparently and accountably.

As an executive partner, my communication style is rooted in pragmatism, flexibility, and a holistic view of branch operations. I reject rigid, transactional administration that schedules meetings simply for the sake of inertia; if an agenda is clear and a node is functioning smoothly, I believe in protecting an executive's calendar to maximize deep-work execution space. However, I recognize that isolation is equally hazardous. Moving past the insufficient monthly alignment models common in large organizations, I favor a nimble, high-value communication rhythm tailored entirely to the fluid needs of the Chief Officer. I operate with high autonomy to clear the deck of daily friction, handle sensitive information with absolute discretion, and ensure documentation is flawlessly critiqued before it ever reaches the public eye.

Ultimately, I subscribe to the firm conviction that heroes come in teams, not as isolated individuals. My purpose in this role is to absorb the administrative noise, optimize workflow structures, and manage cross-functional metrics so your engineering leadership can focus entirely on delivering vital public works to the Seattle community.

Thank you for your time, consideration, and dedication to public service. I look forward to discussing how my quantitative background and executive operations toolkit can support the PDEB team.

Sincerely,

Preston Carey Leslie

